Digital Literacy Project Report

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Introduction

This project is about understanding how students can use the digital world in a smarter and more responsible way. It covers building a professional online presence, communicating properly, and making effective use of different platforms for learning and collaboration. As a Digital Ambassador, the goal is to spread awareness among peers about safe and ethical online behavior. It also looks at common cyber threats like phishing and how to avoid them. Overall, the project focuses on developing awareness, good habits, and the ability to make better decisions while using digital technology in everyday life.

Task 1: Presentation

For this task, I designed a one-page visual guide using Canva to explain digital literacy in a simple and relatable way for my batchmates. While creating it, my main focus was to keep the layout clean and easy to understand at a glance. Instead of adding too much text, I divided the content into three clear sections: understanding digital literacy, building a digital presence, and staying safe online.

In the first section, I explained what digital literacy actually means—using technology to find, evaluate, and create information effectively. Then, I included a section on building a digital presence, highlighting how platforms like LinkedIn and GitHub can reflect who we are professionally. The final part focuses on online safety, where I added practical points like using strong passwords, avoiding suspicious links, and being aware of scams.

The most challenging part was managing space. It was not easy to fit everything into one page without making it look crowded. This made me think more about design choices like spacing, icons, and headings. Overall, this task helped me understand that presenting information clearly is just as important as the content itself.

Task 2: Portfolio Setup

I selected Kaggle, Stack Overflow, and ResearchGate based on my interests and how useful they can be for my growth during the course of my degree.

Stack Overflow is a platform I can use whenever I face problems while coding. It has a large community where developers share answers and help each other. I plan to use it to find solutions, and later, as I gain confidence, I would like to help others by answering simple questions.

ResearchGate is mainly used for academic learning and research. It gives access to research papers and work being done in different fields. I plan to use it to learn more about topics in computer science, especially while doing projects or preparing for higher studies.

Kaggle is a platform mainly used for data science and machine learning. It offers real datasets, competitions, and shared notebooks. I find it useful for practicing real-world problems and improving my coding skills. As I get better, I also plan to take part in competitions to challenge myself and learn from others.

Over the next four years, I believe these platforms will help me stay consistent, improve my problem-solving ability, and keep learning beyond the classroom.

Task 3: Platforms Activity:

For this task, I used Google Workspace tools and HackerRank. I created a digital literacy awareness quiz using Google Forms for my classmates. The quiz had mostly multiple-choice questions along with one short answer question to get more detailed responses. It included topics like online safety, password habits, and common scams. While making it, I learned how to frame simple and clear questions and collect responses in an organized way. I also explored how to view and understand the results.

On HackerRank, I solved a beginner-level problem called “Solve Me First” using Python. Even though it was a basic question, it helped me understand how the platform works and how to write and submit code there.

Both of these tools will be useful for me academically. Google Workspace can help in creating forms, working on group projects, and organizing information. HackerRank will help me improve my coding skills through regular practice, especially in Python.

Task 4 Email Etiquette:

Do's

• Follow pages and people that add value (learning, networking, opportunities).

• Always acknowledge sources when sharing content or ideas.

• Set boundaries to avoid distraction from academics and real-life interactions.

• Build a profile (e.g., projects, internships, achievements).

• Maintain a polite tone, even during disagreements.

Don'ts

• Don't use social media during important academic time.

• Don't post content that could affect future opportunities.

• Don't trust unknown links or profiles

• Avoid posting sensitive data like address, phone number, or schedules.

• Don't ignore digital wellbeing

A common problem with email communication happens when a student sends a message that is unclear or incomplete. For example, a student might write something like, "I have an issue, please help," without adding a subject line or explaining which course or problem they are referring to. In such cases, the professor may not understand the situation or might ignore the email because it lacks proper details.This can cause delays or even missed opportunities, especially if the matter is urgent, like a deadline or attendance issue. It also gives a poor impression of the student's professionalism.This could be avoided by writing a clear subject line, explaining the issue properly, and including all the necessary details.

Keeping the tone polite and ending the email properly can also make a big difference and increase the chances of getting a response.

Task 5: Cybercrime Case Study:

What surprised me the most while learning about phishing is how simple these scams actually are. They don't use very advanced technology, but still manage to fool people just by creating urgency or looking real. Even a normal-looking email or website can trick someone easily.

Because of this, one habit I will change is being more careful before clicking on any link or message. I will always check if the source is real and avoid taking quick actions without thinking. This small step can help me stay safe from such scams.

Conclusion:

This project helped me understand digital literacy in a more practical and simple way. It was not just about learning new tools, but also about how to use them properly and responsibly. From making a visual guide to creating online profiles and trying platforms like GitHub and HackerRank, each task helped me learn something useful. I also understood the importance of proper communication and staying safe online through email writing and the cybercrime task.

One important thing I learned is that just being active online is not enough; we also need to be careful and professional. Overall, this project improved my basic technical skills and made me more aware of how to use the internet in a safe and responsible way, which will help me in the future.

References:

· Canva: Used for visual design and infographic generation (Task 1).

· Kaggle, Stack Overflow, ResearchGate: Platforms utilized for establishing a professional digital portfolio (Task 2).

· HackerRank: Utilized for Java programming practice (Task 3).

· Google Workspace (Forms & Sheets): Utilized for quiz creation and data collaboration (Task 3).

· National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal: Reference for reporting channels in India (cybercrime.gov.in) (Task 5).